

THE TIP

Draft 2 - branching sequence

INT. PORT AUTHORITY OFFICE - NIGHT

VIC meets **DANA** in the stairwell they always use when Dana has something she shouldn't. Dana presses a folded shipping manifest into Vic's hand before either of them says a word.

DANA

Whatever you do with this, it didn't come from me.

VIC

It never does.

Vic has three ways she could play this: go confront the shipping foreman directly with what's on the manifest, stake out the warehouse first and see who actually shows up, or head straight for the harbor place to ask around before she tips her hand anywhere else.

FOREMAN CONFRONTATION

INT. SHIPPING OFFICE - DAY

Vic drops the manifest on Reyes's desk without any preamble. He doesn't even look surprised, which tells her everything the paperwork didn't.

REYES

You're going to want to sit down for this part.

By the time he's done talking, Reyes has told her more than he meant to, and they both know it.

FOREMAN ENDING

INT. SHIPPING OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Vic folds the manifest back up and pockets it. Whatever happens with Reyes from here isn't part of tonight - the sequence ends with her walking out the same door she came in.

WAREHOUSE STAKEOUT

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Vic settles into the car across the lot, engine off, watching the loading doors for anything that doesn't belong. Full two-day shoot on this one - we need the exterior stakeout covered across both a rainy night and a clear one before we can cut it together.

Nothing moves for a long time. Then, close to dawn on the second night, a truck she doesn't recognize backs up to the loading doors.

WAREHOUSE BREAK-IN

INT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - LATER THAT NIGHT

Vic slips through the side door once the truck pulls out again. One-day shoot for this one - one night, one location, we get the ledger reveal in a single take or we don't get it at all.

The ledger is exactly where the manifest said it would be.

LEDGER CALL

INT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

The ledger's still open in her hands when she finally reaches for the phone, thumb hovering over Hale's number without pressing down on it yet.

ROOFTOP PURSUIT

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE ROOF - CONTINUOUS

The call barely rings twice before headlights swing across the lot below, and Vic is already moving, ledger tucked under one arm, taking the fire escape two rungs at a time. Whatever was on that truck, it isn't done with her yet.

CAPTAIN DEBRIEF

INT. PRECINCT - LATER

Vic sets the ledger down on Captain Hale's desk without a word, still catching her breath from the drive over.

HALE

Tell me this isn't what I think it is.

Vic doesn't answer, which is answer enough.

PRECINCT EPILOGUE

INT. 14TH STREET STATION - MOMENTS LATER

Hale pages back through the ledger at his desk, same tired fluorescent lighting overhead as always, while Vic waits by the door for whatever comes next. Whatever that turns out to be isn't part of tonight - the sequence ends here.

HARBOR PLACE INQUIRY

Vic skips the warehouse and the shipping office both and heads straight for the harbor place to ask around

before she shows her hand anywhere else. Nobody there is in a hurry to talk, and by the time anyone does, the trail's already gone cold. The sequence ends with her walking back to the car with nothing to show for it.